



VINEETA SINGH

40, CO-FOUNDER AND CEO, SUGAR COSMETICS

82 | BEYOND THE GLAMOUR

VINEETA SINGH is a household name today, a face of entrepreneurship and a champion of women-led businesses, all thanks to

Shark Tank India.

However, beyond the spotlight, Singh, alongside her Co-founder and husband Kaushik Mukherjee,

is driving SUGAR Cosmetics towards expansive growth in the dynamic beauty landscape. She says the company saw a 90 per cent increase in revenues in financial year 2022-23, totalling ₹428.4 crore, coupled with a 15 per cent improvement in the bottom line.

What's the next big goal? Turning profitable, she says. Singh is aiming to ensure that Q3 and Q4 are in the black, riding the wave of festive season demand. Zooming out, the plan is to hit Ebitda break-even by FY24.

"Our aim has always been that once we come close to the ₹500-crore net revenue mark, we will optimise our marketing and start looking at profitability. From here to the ₹2,000-crore net revenue zone, we plan to

accomplish profitability," she tells *Business Today*.

Singh envisions a profitable business with 40-50 per cent annual growth, leading India's colour cosmetics scene, and elevating international revenue to 10 per cent in the next two years. Amidst the hustle and bustle, she's clear in her commitment to empowering women. "Currently, 70 per cent of SUGAR's employee base is women, about 3,000. As the brand grows, that should become 10,000. I have a portfolio of more than 20 firms, thanks to *Shark Tank*, and 70 per cent of them have at least one woman co-founder. I'm looking forward to investing in at least 20 more via *Shark Tank* and outside," she says. **BT**

— BY BINU PAUL

WHAT KEEPS ME GOING

Working with ambitious and confident Indian women customers and colleagues

A LIFE LESSON LEARNT ON THE JOB

The most unexpected gift in life is early failure

Taking the Long View

For Vinati Saraf Mutreja, a big lesson from her professional journey has been to not shy away from taking long-term bets. "Identifying the correct product segment is key to growth," says Mutreja, MD & CEO of Vinati Organics Limited (VOL), which produces nearly 30 diverse chemicals,

and sees around two-thirds of its sales coming from exports. The last few years have been good for VOL, with FY23 seeing ₹2,000 crore in revenues, its best-ever performance, she says. "We kept optimising our costs, front-running the demand, and entering new product segments," she explains. With manufacturing costs remaining low, her plan is to expand existing capacity and introduce new products. **BT**

— BY NEETU CHANDRA SHARMA



VINATI SARAF MUTREJA

39, MD & CEO, VINATI ORGANICS LIMITED